Liliw Virtual Guide — User Manual

A web-based tourism platform for the Municipality of Liliw, Laguna, developed for the Culture, History, Arts and Tourism Office (CHATO).

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1. Introduction

1.1 About the System

The Liliw Virtual Guide is a Progressive Web Application (PWA) that lets visitors discover Liliw's heritage sites, dining spots, footwear shops, accommodations, and cultural stories; plan a trip with AI assistance or curated itineraries; check in at attractions using QR codes to earn points and rewards; and read narrated local stories told by an animated 3D storyteller, **Gat Tayaw**.

It also gives the municipality's tourism office the tools to manage that content, review it before publication, and support local business owners who want to be listed.

1.2 Who Uses This System

Role	What they do
Tourist / Visitor	Browses the site, plans trips, checks in at attractions, earns points, leaves reviews
Local Business Owner (LBO)	Applies to have their business listed, manages their listing, submits visitor records
CHATO Editor	Creates and edits content (attractions, stories, events, news, etc.)
CHATO Officer	Reviews and approves or rejects content submitted by Editors

Role	What they do
Administrator	Manages user accounts, staff accounts, and oversees the whole system

1.3 Accessing the System

The system is a website reachable from any modern browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge) on a phone, tablet, or computer — no installation required. It can optionally be "installed" as an app on a phone's home screen, and continues to work with reduced functionality when the connection drops, since previously visited pages are cached.

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2. Getting Started

2.1 Creating an Account

11. Click **Login** (top right) and select **Sign Up**.
12. Enter your **username** (5–12 characters, letters, numbers and underscores), a valid **email address**, and a **password**.
13. **Password requirements:** at least 8 characters, including one uppercase letter, one lowercase letter, one number, and one special character.
14. Submit the form. Every new account starts as a regular visitor account.

Browsing the site, viewing attractions, and using the chatbot **do not require an account**. An account is required to check in via QR, earn points, save trips, leave reviews, and apply as a business owner.

2.2 Signing In

Use your email and password on the **Login** page. Signing in as a Business Owner, CHATO Officer, CHATO Editor, or Administrator automatically opens the correct dashboard for that role instead of the homepage.

2.3 Forgot Password

Click **Forgot Password** on the login screen, enter your email, and follow the one-time code sent to you to set a new password.

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3. Guide for Tourists and Visitors

3.1 Exploring Attractions

The **Explore** menu leads to five categories, each with its own listing page:

- **Attractions / Tourist Spots** — heritage sites and natural spots

- **Heritage** — historical landmarks such as the parish church and ancestral houses
- **Dining** — restaurants, cafés, and food stalls
- **Footwear** — Liliw's signature *tsinelas* (slipper) shops
- **Accommodations** — places to stay

Each listing can be filtered by category and searched by name. Selecting a card opens its detail page: photos, description, location, entrance fee, operating hours, contact information, a map, and visitor reviews.

3.2 Searching the Site

Use the search bar in the top navigation to search across attractions, dining spots, footwear stores, accommodations, stories, events, news, and itineraries at once. Results are grouped, with places (attractions, dining, footwear, accommodations) shown first and separately from articles and guides.

3.3 Stories of Liliw

The **Stories** page presents Liliw's history and culture as a set of short, narrated chapters — the legend of the town's name, the parish church, the slipper trade, ancestral houses, and more. Each story is shown one at a time, in full, alongside **Gat Tayaw**, an animated 3D storyteller who can read the story aloud.

- Use the **arrows** or the chapter bar at the bottom to move between stories.
- Press **Listen** to have Gat Tayaw narrate the story; toggle **EN / FIL** to switch between English and Filipino narration.
- Each story may include a photo gallery beneath the text.

3.4 Planning a Trip

Open **Itinerary** to either:

- **Ask the AI planner** to generate a day-by-day itinerary based on how much time you have and what you're interested in (heritage, dining, nature, shopping, etc.), built only from real, published places in the system; or
- **Browse curated tours** — themed, ready-made itineraries prepared by the tourism office.

Every itinerary includes a **map with road-accurate routing** between stops (following actual streets and one-way rules, not a straight line) and can be **saved to your profile**. A saved itinerary becomes a **checklist**: as you check in at each place using its QR code, that stop is automatically ticked off, so you can see at a glance which places on your trip you've already visited.

3.5 Checking In and Earning Points

At participating attractions, businesses, and dining spots, look for a **QR code poster** near the entrance.

15. Open **Scan** in the navigation (or tap it from an attraction's page).
16. Allow camera access and point your camera at the QR code.

17. The system verifies you are physically near the location before crediting the visit — you must be at the place, not just anywhere, to check in.
18. A successful check-in awards **points**, may unlock an **achievement**, and marks the place as visited on any itinerary that includes it.

3.6 Points, Achievements, and Rewards

Your **Profile** page shows your total points, unlocked achievements, and visit history. Points can be redeemed in the **Rewards** section for items or perks the tourism office has made available. Some achievements are awarded for milestones such as visiting a certain number of places, checking in during a festival, or sharing an attraction.

3.7 Writing a Review

You may leave a rating and written review on an attraction's page **only after** you have a credited visit there (via QR check-in) — this keeps reviews honest and tied to an actual visit.

3.8 Favorites and the Gallery

Tap the heart icon on any listing to save it to your **Favorites**, viewable from your profile. The **Gallery** page collects every published photo across the site by category; tapping a photo takes you directly to the attraction, artisan, story, or news item it belongs to.

3.9 Community and Participation

The **Community** page lists local events you can join (festivals, clean-up drives, volunteer activities) and lets you sign up. **Participate** offers additional ways to get involved with the tourism office, such as submitting stories or suggestions.

3.10 Virtual Tours

The **3D Tour** section offers 360° virtual walkthroughs of select attractions with clickable hotspots, useful for previewing a place before visiting or exploring it remotely.

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4. Guide for Local Business Owners (LBO)

4.1 Applying to Be Listed

19. Go to **Tourism → Apply as a Business** (or **Profile → Apply as LBO** if you are already signed in as a tourist — no account is required to apply either way).
20. Fill in your business name, owner name, contact details, address, business type, and (optionally) your DTI/permit number. You may also attach supporting documents (JPG, PNG, WEBP, or PDF).
21. Submit. Your application is reviewed by CHATO; you will be notified once it is **approved**.

4.2 Your Business Dashboard

Once approved, signing in takes you directly to your **LBO Dashboard** (`/lbo`), which has several sections:

- **Your Listing** — shows both:
  - **Business Details**: what CHATO holds on file (name, owner, contact, address, permit number). Fields left blank show **"Not submitted yet"** with a button to supply them.
  - **Your public listing**: the attraction page visitors see, with your photos, description, and location.
  - **Check-In QR Poster**: a printable poster with your unique QR code. Display it at your entrance so visitors can check in and earn points there.
  - **360° Virtual Tour** status, with a button to request one if you don't have one yet.
- **Requests** — submit a **Change Request** for any detail you need corrected (name, description, contact number, address, hours, fee, photos, business type, or permit number). Changes are reviewed by CHATO before they appear publicly — you cannot edit your own public listing directly.
- **Visitor Records** — submit your **monthly visitor counts** (broken down by origin and gender), which CHATO uses for tourism statistics.
- **Ratings** — view the reviews and average rating visitors have left for your business.

4.3 Requesting a New Attraction Listing

If your business has not yet been linked to a public listing, the dashboard lets you submit a request for CHATO to create one.

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5. Guide for CHATO Editors

Editors create and edit content but **cannot publish it themselves** — every change goes through an Officer for review. This separation ensures nothing reaches the public site unchecked.

5.1 Content You Can Manage

From the **CMS** (`/cms`), Editors manage nine content types: **Attractions, Events, News, Art Forms, Artisans, Stories, FAQs, Itineraries,** and **Community Events**.

5.2 The Publishing Workflow

Every piece of content moves through a fixed sequence of states:

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Draft  →  Submitted for Review  →  Approved (live)   or   Rejected (back to you)
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22. **Create or edit** an entry — it saves as a **Draft**, invisible to the public.
23. Fill in the required fields (name/title, description, category, location, etc.) and add photos. The system checks your entries for obvious problems (nonsense text, missing required fields, out-of-range numbers) before you can submit.
24. Click **Submit for Review**. The entry moves to **Pending**.

25. A CHATO Officer approves or rejects it.
    - **Approved** → goes live on the public site within a couple of minutes.
    - **Rejected** → comes back to you with the Officer's written reason. Fix the issue and submit again.

> **Important:** Editing an already-published entry sends it back to **Draft** and takes it off the public site until it is re-approved — even for a small correction. Submit promptly after editing.

5.3 Stories: Narration and Photos

For Stories specifically, you can:

- Upload **audio narration** (MP3, English and Filipino separately) that plays through Gat Tayaw, or leave it blank to let the system pick a suitable built-in narration automatically.
- Write a short line for the **storyteller's speech bubble**.
- Upload **up to eight photos** — the first becomes the cover image; the rest form the story's photo gallery.

5.4 Managing Photos

Each content type supports uploading photos directly in the entry form. Images are stored securely and automatically optimized for the website.

5.5 Archiving Content

Content that should no longer be public can be **archived** rather than deleted, preserving its history and any points, reviews, or check-ins tied to it.

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6. Guide for CHATO Officers

Officers **review and publish** content but do not create it themselves — this keeps publishing decisions separate from authorship.

6.1 The Approval Queue

Content Approvals lists every entry currently **Pending**. For each one, you can:

- **View** the submission, including a side-by-side comparison against the previously approved version (for edits), so you can see exactly what changed.
- **Approve** — publishes it immediately.
- **Reject** — requires a written reason, which is sent back to the Editor.

Multiple entries can be **selected and approved or rejected together** (batch action) when reviewing a large queue.

6.2 Other Officer Responsibilities

- **Approving LBO applications** and business change requests.
- **Restoring archived content** back to Draft status if it needs to return.
- Officers **cannot** create, edit, or archive content themselves — only Editors and Admins can.

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7. Guide for Administrators

Administrators have full access, combining the powers of Editor and Officer, plus system-wide management tools.

7.1 Dashboard Overview

The **Admin Dashboard** (`/admin`) shows headline statistics (page views, registered users, pending actions), how many people are actively browsing the site right now, and quick links to every management area.

7.2 User Management

- View all registered users, filter by role (Tourist, LBO, CHATO Officer, CHATO Editor, Admin).
- **Deactivate** an account (reversible) rather than deleting it — this preserves the account's points, reviews, and check-in history while preventing sign-in.
- **Create staff accounts** (CHATO Editors and Officers) directly.

7.3 Inbox

A unified inbox collects **contact form submissions, business applications, change requests, event sign-ups,** and other inquiries in one place, so nothing has to be checked in five different tables.

7.4 Reports and Analytics

Exportable reports cover attraction ratings, visitor totals, submissions, event sign-ups, and page-view analytics over a chosen date range.

7.5 Audit Log

Every content action (create, submit, approve, reject, archive, restore) is recorded with who performed it and when, for accountability.

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8. Lilio, the AI Assistant

Lilio is the chat assistant available on every page (bottom-right chat bubble). Ask it things like:

- "Where should I eat in Liliw?"
- "How do I get to Kilangin Falls?"

- "What is Liliw known for?"
- "How do check-ins and points work?"
- "Can you plan a one-day trip for me?"

Lilio answers using the site's actual published content — attractions, events, FAQs, and how the system itself works — rather than generic information, so its answers stay specific to Liliw. It periodically shows a rotating suggestion bubble if you haven't opened the chat yet; tapping a suggestion opens the chat with that question ready to send.

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9. Frequently Asked Questions

Do I need an account to browse the site? No. Browsing, searching, reading stories, and chatting with Lilio work without signing in. An account is needed to check in, save trips, earn points, and leave reviews.

Why can't I leave a review on a place I haven't visited? Reviews are gated on a **credited QR check-in**, so ratings reflect real visits.

I submitted a story/attraction edit and it disappeared from the site — is that a bug? No — editing published content sends it back for re-approval, which is why it's temporarily off the public site.

Why didn't my QR check-in work? The system confirms you are physically near the attraction's coordinates before crediting a visit. Make sure location/camera permissions are allowed and you are at the actual location.

Can I use the site offline? Pages you've already visited remain available, and a banner will prompt you to reload when a newer version of the site is published.

What languages does Gat Tayaw narrate in? English and Filipino, toggled with the EN/FIL button next to the Listen control.

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10. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
Can't sign in	Check your password meets the requirements; use **Forgot Password** if needed
QR scan not working	Allow camera permission in your browser; ensure you are at the location
Chatbot not responding	Check your internet connection; try again after a few seconds
Storyteller/3D content not showing	Your browser or device may not support WebGL — a static illustration is shown instead automatically
Page looks outdated	Look for an "A new version is available — Reload" banner and tap Reload

Problem	What to try
Can't submit a CMS entry	Check for a red validation message under the field — required fields and photo limits are enforced

For issues not covered here, use the **Contact** page to reach the CHATO office directly.

Liliw Virtual Guide — Culture, History, Arts and Tourism Office (CHATO), Municipality of Liliw, Laguna.